

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Extreme heat

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move to air conditioning or a designated cooling space, reduce exertion and drink water regularly unless your clinician restricts fluids. Confusion, collapse or seizures in heat can mean heat stroke: call emergency services and start rapid cooling.

Do now.

- ☐ **Find a cooler place**
01 Use air conditioning, a public cooling center or another safe indoor location.
- ☐ **Reduce heat load**
02 Rest, loosen unnecessary clothing and use cool wet cloths or a cool shower.
- ☐ **Check on others**
03 Older adults, infants, outdoor workers and people with illness may need help. Never leave anyone or pets in a parked vehicle.
- ☐ **Recognize an emergency**
04 For altered mental status or collapse, call emergency services and cool the person while waiting; do not give drinks to someone unable to swallow.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use the coolest reachable space, wet skin or cloths, reduce activity and check vulnerable people repeatedly. A closed room can become more dangerous than outdoor shade. If indoor heat becomes intolerable, move early to a safer location rather than waiting for power to return.

Watch for.

Heat stroke can occur with sweating. Do not wait for dry skin.

People & practical needs.

Check infants, older adults and people taking medicines that affect heat tolerance. Share the cooling plan in a form everyone can understand and name a person responsible for check-ins

Next decision.

Plan activities for cooler hours and follow heat alerts. Arrange safe transport before the home becomes dangerously hot.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Extreme heat · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/extreme-heat/>